

1. According to the Declaration of Independence, governments get their just powers from
0.25 Pts
the king.

Parliament.

the Church of England.

the consent of the governed.

2. Britain gave the United States generous terms in 1783 mainly because it wanted to
keep France from regaining power in North America.

reward the Americans for staying neutral toward Spain.

win American help in a future war.

stop an American invasion of Canada.

3. Colonies with the highest share of enslaved people showed the least support for the Revolution
mainly because

planters feared losing their enslaved workers if the war went badly.

most enslaved people there were already free.

the British had banned slavery in those colonies.

those colonies had no militias.

4. During the British retreat from Concord to Boston in April 1775, colonial militia
surrendered after the first volley.

fired from cover along the road, a form of guerrilla warfare.

stood in lines and fought in the European style.

let the British pass to avoid starting a war.

5. During the peace talks in Paris, the American diplomats were told to follow France's lead but
instead

refused to negotiate at all.

asked Spain to take the lead.

let Congress write the treaty.

dealt with Britain directly, because France wanted a weak United States.

6. Fighting in the South between 1778 and 1781 was often

0.25 Pts

limited to a few large battles between regular armies.

a brutal small-unit civil war between Loyalists and Patriots.

avoided by both sides until Yorktown.

led by Spanish troops.

7. In the Declaration of Independence, each grievance beginning "He has..." refers to King George III.

Parliament.

General Gage.

Lord Dunmore.

8. Jefferson used "the pursuit of happiness" instead of Locke's word "property" because property belonged to the king under English law.

property sounded too economic for a statement of rights.

Franklin wanted a shorter phrase.

the southern delegates demanded it.

9. Many southerners during the war in the South were most willing to support the Patriots, because of the Declaration of Independence.

the British, because most were Loyalists.

whichever side could bring stability to their area.

the French, because of the alliance.

10. On May 10, 1776, the Second Continental Congress recommended that the colonies replace their colonial governments with new state governments.

ask France for an alliance.

send the Olive Branch Petition to the king.

adopt the Articles of Confederation.

11. Spain got Florida back in 1783 because it

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was a formal ally of the United States.

bought it from the United States.

had fought Britain, and Britain did not want to run Florida anyway.

had never lost it in 1763.

12. The "shot heard round the world" refers to

the first shot of the war, fired at Lexington in 1775.

the cannon fire that drove the British out of Boston.

the American victory at Saratoga.

the French fleet's attack off the Chesapeake.

13. The British left Boston in March 1776 mainly because

France had declared war on Britain.

the Continental Congress had agreed to a truce.

cannons taken at Fort Ticonderoga were placed on the heights above the city.

smallpox had broken out in the city.

14. The First Continental Congress sent the Declaration of Rights and Grievances (1774) mainly to

protest the Coercive Acts and defend the colonists' rights as Englishmen.

announce that the colonies were independent.

form an alliance with France.

approve the Articles of Confederation.

15. The main reason the British army surrendered at Saratoga in 1777 was that

the French navy blocked the Hudson River.

Loyalists in New York turned against it.

Americans cut its supply lines until it ran out of food and supplies.

the British commander was captured early in the campaign.

16. The Second Continental Congress differed from the First Continental Congress in that the Second

0.25 Pts

met only to answer the Coercive Acts.

refused to raise an army.

was elected by Parliament.

met after fighting began and acted as a wartime government.

17. The winter at Valley Forge (1777 to 1778) mattered because

European officers trained the army into a professional force.

the army won its first battle there.

Congress moved there from Philadelphia.

the French army joined Washington there.

18. Thomas Jefferson was chosen to write the Declaration of Independence mainly because

he was the oldest member of the committee.

he had written Common Sense.

he was considered the best writer on the committee.

he was the only Virginian in the Congress.

19. Thomas Paine argued in Common Sense that America's advantages included

its powerful navy and professional army.

its distance from England, its land, and its size.

the support of every colonist.

its alliance with Spain.

20. Under the Franco-American Alliance of 1778, France sent the United States

a loan to pay off debts to British merchants.

control of Canada.

settlers for the western lands.

troops, military advisors, gunpowder and a naval fleet.

21. Under the Treaty of Paris (1783), Loyalists whose land had been confiscated

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received full payment from Congress.

could use American courts to try to get it back, but almost none succeeded.

were given land in the Northwest instead.

could return only if they paid a fine.

22. Which of the following was a provision of the Treaty of Paris (1783)?

Britain kept the land west of the Appalachians.

France received Canada.

The United States gave up fishing off Newfoundland.

Britain agreed to leave its forts in the Northwest.

23. Answer (a), (b), and (c).

1 Pts

(a) Briefly describe ONE way the goals of the Second Continental Congress changed between 1775 and 1776.

(b) Briefly explain ONE cause of that change.

(c) Briefly explain ONE way the Declaration of Independence justified the break with Britain.

Answer Key

1. According to the Declaration of Independence, governments get their just powers from

0.25 Pts

the king.

Parliament.

the Church of England.

the consent of the governed.

Why: Power comes from the people; if a government destroys their rights, they may change it.

2. Britain gave the United States generous terms in 1783 mainly because it wanted to

keep France from regaining power in North America.

reward the Americans for staying neutral toward Spain.

win American help in a future war.

stop an American invasion of Canada.

Why: Britain hated France more than it hated America.

3. Colonies with the highest share of enslaved people showed the least support for the Revolution mainly because

planters feared losing their enslaved workers if the war went badly.

most enslaved people there were already free.

the British had banned slavery in those colonies.

those colonies had no militias.

Why: If the Patriots lost, Britain might free the enslaved, and that was where southern wealth was tied up.

4. During the British retreat from Concord to Boston in April 1775, colonial militia

surrendered after the first volley.

fired from cover along the road, a form of guerrilla warfare.

stood in lines and fought in the European style.

let the British pass to avoid starting a war.

Why: Small units shot from hiding and moved on; the British took heavy losses.

5. During the peace talks in Paris, the American diplomats were told to follow France's lead but instead

0.25 Pts

refused to negotiate at all.

asked Spain to take the lead.

let Congress write the treaty.

dealt with Britain directly, because France wanted a weak United States.

Why: France hated Britain more than it liked America, so the diplomats went around it.

6. Fighting in the South between 1778 and 1781 was often limited to a few large battles between regular armies.

a brutal small-unit civil war between Loyalists and Patriots.

avoided by both sides until Yorktown.

led by Spanish troops.

Why: Neighbors fought neighbors, and most people sided with whoever brought stability.

7. In the Declaration of Independence, each grievance beginning "He has..." refers to King George III.

Parliament.

General Gage.

Lord Dunmore.

Why: The colonists held that Parliament never had power over them; the king let it violate their rights.

8. Jefferson used "the pursuit of happiness" instead of Locke's word "property" because property belonged to the king under English law.

property sounded too economic for a statement of rights.

Franklin wanted a shorter phrase.

the southern delegates demanded it.

Why: The reason given is that property sounded too economic.

9. Many southerners during the war in the South were most willing to support

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the Patriots, because of the Declaration of Independence.

the British, because most were Loyalists.

whichever side could bring stability to their area.

the French, because of the alliance.

Why: After years of raids and executions, order mattered more than the cause.

10. On May 10, 1776, the Second Continental Congress recommended that the colonies

replace their colonial governments with new state governments.

ask France for an alliance.

send the Olive Branch Petition to the king.

adopt the Articles of Confederation.

Why: The Articles came later (1781); the Olive Branch was 1775.

11. Spain got Florida back in 1783 because it

was a formal ally of the United States.

bought it from the United States.

had fought Britain, and Britain did not want to run Florida anyway.

had never lost it in 1763.

Why: Spain fought Britain but was never a U.S. ally; Britain did not want to govern Florida, and Spain was weak.

12. The "shot heard round the world" refers to

the first shot of the war, fired at Lexington in 1775.

the cannon fire that drove the British out of Boston.

the American victory at Saratoga.

the French fleet's attack off the Chesapeake.

Why: Nobody knows who fired it, but it started the war.

13. The British left Boston in March 1776 mainly because

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France had declared war on Britain.

the Continental Congress had agreed to a truce.

cannons taken at Fort Ticonderoga were placed on the heights above the city.

smallpox had broken out in the city.

Why: With guns overlooking the harbor, Boston could not be held.

14. The First Continental Congress sent the Declaration of Rights and Grievances (1774) mainly to

protest the Coercive Acts and defend the colonists' rights as Englishmen.

announce that the colonies were independent.

form an alliance with France.

approve the Articles of Confederation.

Why: It still asked for rights inside the empire; independence came in 1776.

15. The main reason the British army surrendered at Saratoga in 1777 was that

the French navy blocked the Hudson River.

Loyalists in New York turned against it.

Americans cut its supply lines until it ran out of food and supplies.

the British commander was captured early in the campaign.

Why: An army runs on its stomach. France was not in the war yet.

16. The Second Continental Congress differed from the First Continental Congress in that the Second met only to answer the Coercive Acts.

refused to raise an army.

was elected by Parliament.

met after fighting began and acted as a wartime government.

Why: The First answered the Coercive Acts; the Second ran the war.

17. The winter at Valley Forge (1777 to 1778) mattered because

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European officers trained the army into a professional force.

the army won its first battle there.

Congress moved there from Philadelphia.

the French army joined Washington there.

Why: The army that came out in the spring could fight like regulars.

18. Thomas Jefferson was chosen to write the Declaration of Independence mainly because

he was the oldest member of the committee.

he had written Common Sense.

he was considered the best writer on the committee.

he was the only Virginian in the Congress.

Why: Adams pushed for him as the strongest writer. Paine wrote Common Sense.

19. Thomas Paine argued in Common Sense that America's advantages included

its powerful navy and professional army.

its distance from England, its land, and its size.

the support of every colonist.

its alliance with Spain.

Why: Paine saw the ocean and the continent itself as strengths.

20. Under the Franco-American Alliance of 1778, France sent the United States

a loan to pay off debts to British merchants.

control of Canada.

settlers for the western lands.

troops, military advisors, gunpowder and a naval fleet.

Why: The navy mattered most, at Yorktown.

21. Under the Treaty of Paris (1783), Loyalists whose land had been confiscated

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received full payment from Congress.

could use American courts to try to get it back, but almost none succeeded.

were given land in the Northwest instead.

could return only if they paid a fine.

Why: The states had sold the land to Patriots, so courts gave almost none of it back.

22. Which of the following was a provision of the Treaty of Paris (1783)?

Britain kept the land west of the Appalachians.

France received Canada.

The United States gave up fishing off Newfoundland.

Britain agreed to leave its forts in the Northwest.

Why: Britain kept those forts for years anyway, until the Jay Treaty (1794).

23. Answer (a), (b), and (c).

(a) Briefly describe ONE way the goals of the Second Continental Congress changed between 1775 and 1776.

In 1775 the Congress fought to restore the colonists' rights as Englishmen, but by 1776 it sought independence. The Declaration of the Causes and Necessity of Taking Up Arms (July 1775) promised to lay down arms once rights were restored, while the Declaration of Independence (July 4, 1776) cut ties with Britain.

(b) Briefly explain ONE cause of that change.

King George III's refusal to recognize the Olive Branch Petition showed that reconciliation was impossible, and Paine's Common Sense (1776) convinced many colonists to accept a full break.

(c) Briefly explain ONE way the Declaration of Independence justified the break with Britain.

The Declaration argued that governments get their just powers from the consent of the governed and exist to protect unalienable rights. Because its grievances showed King George III violating those rights, the colonists claimed the right to alter or abolish his government.